after which the entire garrison was to withdraw to Dungti that was being prepared as a strong base.

The Chinese took their time before launching five columns into the Demchok Sector, mainly because some of the troops had to be brought down from the Srijap and Yula Sectors. On the morning of 27 October at 5.45 a.m., ten vehicles mounted with MMGs followed by about 200 Chinese soldiers could be seen advancing on Chang Pass. Jemadar Ishe Tundup, a Ladakhi, had two sections under command and he watched the Chinese move steadily towards his positions.

Tundup let the Chinese close in until they were 300 yards from the pass. He then fired the first shot with his 2-inch mortar. This was the signal for the two LMGs and rifles positioned on the pass to open up. Some of the leading vehicles received direct hits and started burning, while the bunched Chinese troops took quite a few casualties. This forced them to fan out amidst the rocky terrain from where they started creeping up on the Indian positions. The MMGs, dismounted from the trucks, were then brought into play, pouring voluminous fire at the Indians. In the next two hours of fighting, one militiaman was killed, while Tundup and four other men were wounded.

Unable to hold the Chinese at bay any longer, Tundup ordered his men to take the wounded and break contact while he stayed and provided covering fire. The men would make it back to Koyul, but Ishe Tundup was killed and the Chinese captured Chang Pass by 9.45 a.m. However, the two sections on the Chang Pass had inflicted enough damage on the Chinese to delay their assault on Dumchole, which the depleted Chinese force could now only approach at 4 p.m. Here too, the one section of 7 J&K Militia made them pay heavily before they disengaged and fell back on Koyul. The Chinese finally occupied Dumchole at 5 p.m.

A second Chinese column of 200 men could be seen approaching Jara-la shortly after daybreak. As there was no road but only a small track leading up to the pass, the Chinese were mounted on ponies. The two sections that were being commanded by an NCO, Havildar Satigian Phunchok, opened fire with 2-inch mortars, LMGs and rifles. The animals scattered and the Chinese went to ground. Despite outnumbering the Indians 10:1, without heavy weapons and fighting from lower ground, the Chinese, for once, were in an uncomfortable and unfamiliar situation. As darkness fell, Phunchok took stock of the situation. A few Chinese soldiers had cut off his position